

309 Make a foil riverbed

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MINS

What you need

- Aluminum foil
- Garden hose
- Items that float

You can make your very own “river” in your backyard. All you need is a long length of aluminum foil and some water. Float bottle caps or containers, or make your own nutshell boats (see below) to race.



*Have a race
with some walnut-
shell boats*

1 Unroll 16 ft (5 m) of aluminum foil. Lay it out flat in the yard or patio (ask permission first)—wherever you want your river to flow. Smooth out any bumps underneath. Point the end toward a flower bed or vegetable garden so that the water isn’t wasted while you play.

2 Carefully fold the sides up to make walls about 2 in (5 cm) high. These will form your riverbanks.

3 Put a garden hose at the top and turn it on just at a trickle. Wait for the water to flow. See how many different things you can float down it.

310 Make walnut-shell boats

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Put a tiny ball of clay in the bottom of walnut-shell halves. Carefully push a toothpick through a leaf or piece of paper to make a sail. Push the toothpick into the clay to serve as a mast.

*Paper
sails*

